POTPRESS · MARKET AND VIABILITY

PotPress market and viability

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.2	2026-10-23	Amish Chadha	Unit cost updated to $1,279 (PPR-DDR-006)
0.1	2026-10-23	Amish Chadha	First market and viability note (kit 1.8 upgrade); prices checked 2026-10-23

PotPress market and viability

PotPress is for small filter factories and the NGOs that start them, competing with imported presses at $3,000 to $3,500 and with one-off local builds. An open design matters because the press is the factory's single largest piece of forming equipment and has to be repaired where the factory is. Prices and benchmarks were checked 2026-10-23. Method: STANDARDS section 23.

Table 1. Market segments.

Segment	Target users and region	Competitive benchmark (cited price)	Estimated cost per unit (USD)	Value proposition
Existing filter factories	Factories in Latin America, Africa and Asia replacing or adding a press	Potters for Peace press, about $3,000 to $3,500 (PPR-PRB-001)	1,279 in parts plus local labour	About 40 % of the imported cost; repairable with local steel and a bottle jack
New factories	NGOs and social enterprises starting production	Nigerian locally built press, about $1,000; Potters Without Borders scissor press, about $2,300 (PPR-PRB-001)	1,279	Open drawings, build plan and QC rack in one package
Universities and labs	Ceramics and water research groups	Penn State low-cost press, under $200 with a 2 t jack (Henry, Maley and Mehta)	1,279	Known, repeatable force and geometry for studies

The product the press serves sells for about $7.50 to $30 per filter where made locally (CDC, 2008), $8 in Cambodia and $10 to $15 in Nicaragua (Akvopedia), and a factory costs about $15,000 to $30,000 to set up (Akvopedia). At the 69 pots per 6 h on paper, the press's parts cost equals the sale price of about 40 to 170 filters, a few days of output.

Open route

Local fabrication shops build the frame from the drawings; city foundries cast the molds from the printed patterns; filter networks and NGOs carry the design to new factories. CERN-OHL-S keeps changes open, and the parametric model lets a factory change the filter size without a new design.

Sources

- Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. "Household Water Treatment Options in Developing Countries: Ceramic Filtration." Fact sheet, 2008 (checked 2026-10-23).
- Akvopedia. "Ceramic Pot Filter." Akvo Foundation wiki (checked 2026-10-23).
- Potters for Peace, Henry, Maley and Mehta (2013) and Potters Without Borders: see PPR-PRB-001.